CLTC Annual Tennis Tournament Rules

April to June 2026

To ensure that everything runs smoothly and successfully the following rules are provided. It is important that everyone abides by these rules.

The main two rules

- **Play your game by the scheduled date**
- **All matches are the best of three sets**

Match Scheduling

All matches are organised between opponents and played by the “Play By” dates. These are cut-off dates rather than target dates. The “Play By” dates are clearly set out on the draw sheets. In the event of very bad weather these dates will be reviewed and amended as required.

You should only enter the tournament if you are available to play on Finals Day.

If you are playing in a singles tournament and find you are unable to continue beyond the next round, you can either grant a walkover to the opposition or concede at match point.

If you are playing in a doubles tournament and find you are unable to continue beyond the next round, it is your responsibility to inform your partner, who then has the option to grant a walkover or to concede at match point.

If you are unable to contact your opponent, cannot agree a time to play by the date set, are not around for any significant time during the tournament or have any queries regarding scheduling, then discuss with the tournament referee.

Please respect the play by dates; it is within the discretion of the referee to scratch a player if they consider that a player is not taking the deadlines seriously. As a general rule, the tournament referee will decide which player is removed and which player progresses, based on the evidence. If the information is inconclusive, the tournament referee will decide on the toss of a coin.

Court Selection and Bookings

You should mutually agree the court surface. If there is a dispute, the person on top in the draw selects the court surface.

Court bookings should be done using the online booking app. Allow at least one and a half hours per match. Courts are at times blocked out for club times, matches and coaching sessions. You should not plan to play your game during these times.

You may ask the club coach if a court might be available during coaching times. Courts may become free during club times. In these cases, club games and coaching will always take precedence.

Tennis Balls

Tennis balls will be provided and please return balls when you finish. Balls are refreshed regularly. You are asked not to open new balls for your game.

Match Play

All matches are best of three sets. The first two sets are decided by a tie breaker at 6-6. If the third set is 6-6, the game continues until one side leads by two games.

If you mutually agree to play a shortened form for the third set (short set or championship tiebreak) this should be by mutual agreement **at the start of the match**.

Any dispute and the full set should be played. If weather or bad light makes further play impossible, the game should be rescheduled and continues from the point the game was suspended.

Line calls

It is up to the receiver to decide a line call and the decision is then final. An umpire will only be used for Finals Day.

Results & Scores

Results (with scores if you would like to display the score) should be entered onto the sheets in the clubhouse at the end of the match. You do not need to inform the tournament referee online.

Late Arrivals

If you are more than 20 minutes late for a scheduled event, you forfeit the first set; if you are more than 30 minutes late you forfeit the match. Forfeits can be avoided if you contact your opponent in advance to agree a rescheduled time.

Substitutions

If you are playing in a doubles tournament and your partner is injured in an early round, speak to the tournament referee. In general, you will not be able to substitute if you have played a complete match or if the proposed substitute has already played in another partnership. However, the tournament referee will discuss unique circumstances with the club committee if it means that it will have a big impact on the tournament.

Good luck and enjoy your matches!

Nic Suggit - Tournament Referee 2026 - 07981578784
Al McCall – Tournament Referee 2026 - 07787423032